

HOUSE No. 554

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

PRESENTED BY:

Carol A. Doherty and Ryan M. Hamilton

To the Honorable Senate and House of Representatives of the Commonwealth of Massachusetts in General Court assembled:

The undersigned legislators and/or citizens respectfully petition for the adoption of the accompanying bill:

An Act establishing comprehensive school counseling programs.

PETITION OF:

NAME:	DISTRICT/ADDRESS:	DATE ADDED:
<i>Carol A. Doherty</i>	<i>3rd Bristol</i>	<i>1/16/2025</i>
<i>James K. Hawkins</i>	<i>2nd Bristol</i>	<i>2/11/2025</i>

HOUSE No. 554

By Representatives Doherty of Taunton and Hamilton of Methuen, a petition (accompanied by bill, House, No. 554) of Carol A. Doherty and James K. Hawkins for legislation to establish school counseling programs. Education.

The Commonwealth of Massachusetts

In the One Hundred and Ninety-Fourth General Court
(2025-2026)

An Act establishing comprehensive school counseling programs.

Be it enacted by the Senate and House of Representatives in General Court assembled, and by the authority of the same, as follows:

1 Chapter 71 of the General Laws, as appearing in the 2020 Official Edition is hereby
2 amended by inserting the following:-

3 “Each public school district shall develop and implement a comprehensive school
4 counseling program that adheres to the Massachusetts Model for Comprehensive School
5 Counseling Programs and ensures all pre-K to grade twelve (12) students will receive school
6 counseling services from licensed school counselors. In accordance with the Model, each school
7 counselor is to spend at least eighty percent (80%) of that school counselor’s time providing
8 direct or indirect services to students. To maintain equity in student access to a school counselor,
9 each district shall provide one (1) school counselor for a maximum of two hundred fifty (250)
10 students, the nationally recommended average.”